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Introduction

What is VPC Network Access Analyzer?

Network Access Analyzer is a feature that identifies unintended network access to your resources on AWS.

1. Understand, verify, and improve your network security posture: Network Access Analyzer helps you to identify unintended network access relative to your security and compliance requirements, enabling you to take steps to improve your network security.
2. Demonstrate compliance: You can use Network Access Analyzer to demonstrate that your network on AWS meets certain compliance requirements.
3. Verify your network security posture - Network Access Analyzer lets you to specify your network security requirements, and identify potential network paths that do not meet your requirements.

Why do you need Network Access Analyzer?

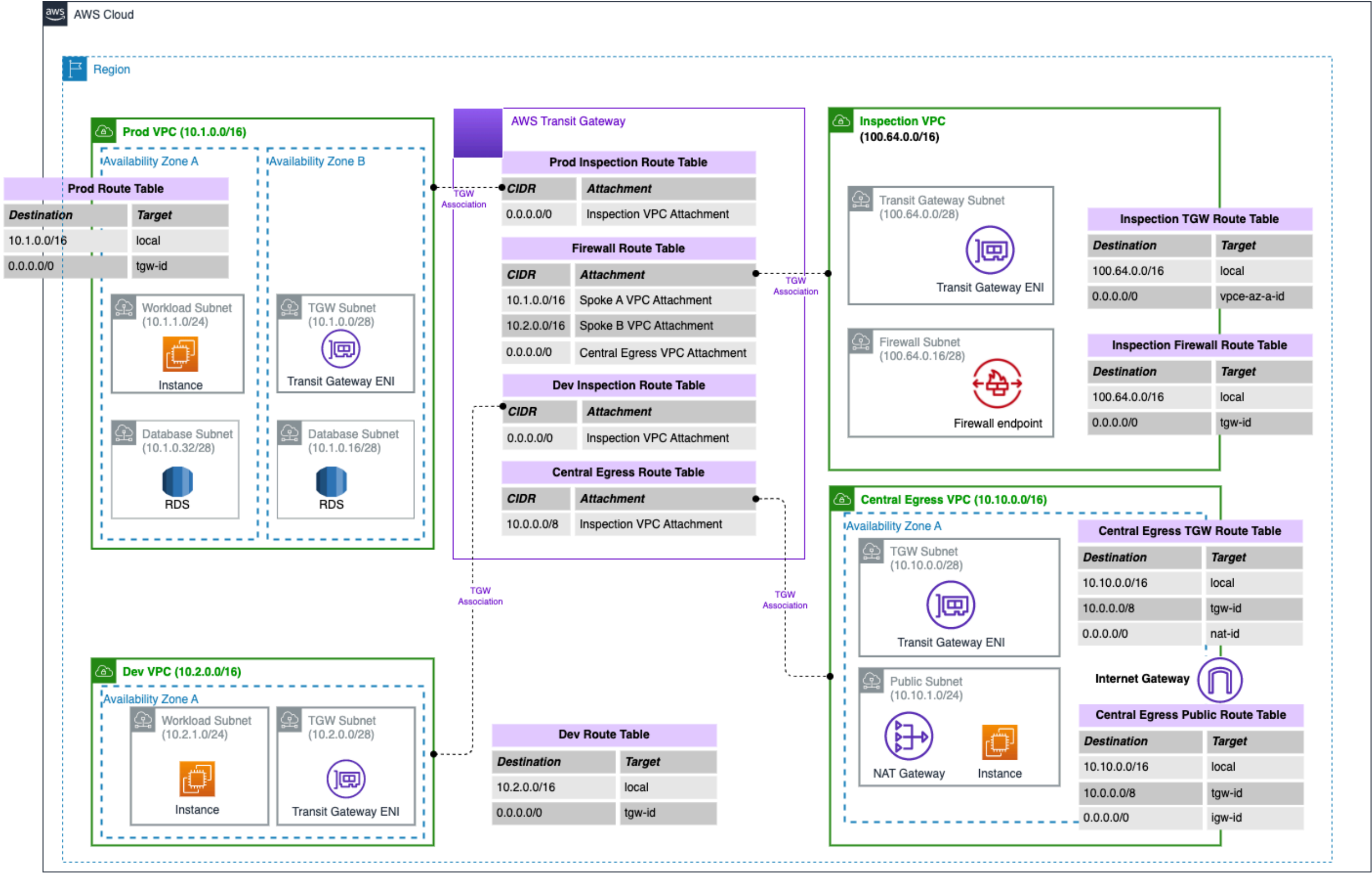
1. Problem statement: As organizations scale their cloud environments and as distributed application teams begin to operate network infrastructure, it can be challenging to determine whether there are sufficient and appropriate network controls to accomplish the organizations overall security and compliance objectives.
2. Tedious and ineffective network control validation: Customers have to manually check and auditing their network designs and configurations, which does not scale. This process is tedious, and not comprehensive in validating their overall network control objectives. Audit is time consuming: Operations and network teams need to demonstrate presence of network controls relative to requirements to their security and infosec teams especially during external audits, and doing it based on these manual network configuration checks is again a tedious and time-consuming task.
3. Network controls become obsolete quickly: Customer environments are dynamic with evolving security mandates, network design changes, and ongoing introduction of new AWS networking services that introduce new connectivity paradigms, rendering all previous manual validation efforts obsolete.
4. Operations teams try to ensure a compliant environment by either restricting developers from using certain AWS services, or incorporating manual approval processes for certain configuration changes. Both of these approaches put operations teams under pressure and application teams in a position where they feel like they cannot move as fast as they want to.

What is VPC Reachability Analyzer?

Reachability Analyzer is a configuration analysis tool that enables you to perform connectivity testing between a source resource and a destination resource in your virtual private clouds (VPCs). When the destination is reachable, Reachability Analyzer produces hop-by-hop details of the virtual network path between the source and the destination. When the destination is not reachable, Reachability Analyzer identifies the blocking component. For example, paths can be blocked by configuration issues in a security group, network ACL, route table, or load balancer.

Architecture Diagram

Below is the architecture which was deployed via AWS CloudFormation and will be used in the labs.



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